



For the President
10 July 2026

Today's Brief

IRAN-GULF: US-Iran ceasefire collapses; Tehran strikes four Gulf-region states.

ENERGY: Oil reverses toward wartime highs as a Hormuz risk premium returns.

UKRAINE-NATO: Deep strikes continue as NATO clears Ukrainian Patriot production.

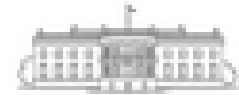
DPRK: Pyongyang formalizes a push to expand its nuclear forces.

CHINA-TAIWAN: Taipei warns Beijing's gray-zone pressure is redrawing the status quo.

GAZA: Ceasefire holds loosely as Cairo talks deadlock.

NOTES: Lebanon, Sudan, China-Philippines.

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US-Iran Ceasefire Collapses; Tehran Strikes Four Gulf-Region States

We assess that the US-Iran interim understanding reached in June has effectively collapsed and that the two sides are now in an open, if still limited, exchange of fire that carries a realistic risk of a wider regional war. Over the past 24 hours US forces conducted a second consecutive night of strikes across Iran, and for the first time Tehran retaliated directly against facilities in four US-partner states -- Kuwait, Bahrain, Qatar, and Jordan. President Trump, speaking from the NATO summit in Ankara, called the ceasefire "over" and further talks a "waste of time," while stopping short of ordering a return to full-scale war.

- US Central Command reported striking roughly 90 targets, concentrated on IRGC coastal missile, drone, and fast-boat assets around Bandar Abbas, Konarak, and Chabahar, and framed the operation as a response to Iranian attacks on three commercial vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz. Press reporting indicates one strike hit a military site near -- not at -- the Bushehr civilian nuclear plant.
- In its first direct retaliation against US partners, Iran launched one-way attack drones at bases in Kuwait, Bahrain, and Qatar and fired an estimated 10 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Azraq air base. Amman says it intercepted eight; Kuwait reported one person injured and damage at several sites. Iran's health ministry claims at least 14 killed and 78 wounded inside Iran over two days.
- Intercepted communications corroborate that the retaliatory salvos were ordered at the IRGC Aerospace Force command level.
- For Washington, the near-term exposure is twofold: US personnel spread across Gulf basing, and the roughly one-fifth of seaborne oil that transits Hormuz. We judge Tehran is signaling resolve and staking out a bargaining position -- asserting a "right" to levy fees on Hormuz traffic -- rather than seeking an all-out war it cannot win.



Behind the strikes, mediation is active. Qatar and Pakistan are working to pull both sides back to the June memorandum, and the UN Secretary-General has urged "maximum restraint."

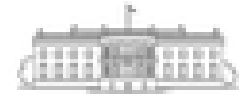
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- The exchange was still developing as of this morning: Iranian state media reported fresh US strikes overnight near Asaluyeh, adjacent to the South Pars gas complex; US forces had not confirmed the strikes, consistent with their practice on ongoing operations.
- A decision point comes if Iran's next salvo produces US casualties or closes Hormuz outright -- either would likely force a choice between de-escalation on Tehran's terms and a broader campaign. We are watching for the movement of additional US air and naval assets into the theater as the clearest indicator of which way Washington leans.

Prepared by ODNI with reporting from CIA, DIA, NSA, NGA, and open sources.

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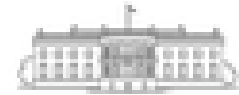
Oil Reverses Toward Wartime Highs as Hormuz Risk Returns

We assess that the renewed US-Iran fighting has reintroduced a war-risk premium into oil that had largely bled out since June, and that prices will stay elevated and headline-sensitive as long as the Strait of Hormuz outcome is unresolved.

- Brent settled about 5% higher near \$78 on 8 July and edged above \$79 on 9 July -- its highest since mid-June -- after Trump declared the ceasefire over and signaled further strikes. Market commentary reads the move as pricing uncertainty, not a closed strait.
- The US Treasury has revoked the temporary suspension of sanctions on Iranian oil granted under the June memorandum, canceling a license that had allowed Iranian crude sales through 21 August.
- Overnight strikes reported near Asaluyeh place Iran's South Pars infrastructure -- one of the world's largest gas fields -- inside the risk picture; damage to processing or export capacity there would tighten gas and LNG markets, not only crude.
- For the US economy the exposure runs through pump prices and inflation expectations; for Gulf partners it is direct and immediate. We expect coordinated messaging from major producers and the IEA to cap panic, but a genuine Hormuz disruption would overwhelm available spare capacity.

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Ukraine Trades Deep Strikes With Russia as NATO Clears Patriot Production

We assess the war remains locked in a mutual long-range strike campaign, with neither side achieving a decisive battlefield shift, even as Kyiv banks meaningful gains from this week's NATO summit in Ankara.

- Overnight Russia launched two ballistic missiles and roughly 94 drones; Ukraine reported downing 72, with missile and drone impacts still recorded. Strikes across Kharkiv and Kherson oblasts wounded civilians, including passengers on a minibus in central Kherson.
- Ukraine struck deep in return, hitting an oil terminal at Tver and reporting attacks on a dozen Russian tankers, a tug, and a dry-cargo ship in the Sea of Azov as well as an oil-loading terminal in the Rostov region -- part of a sustained campaign against Russian energy and logistics.
- Overhead imagery shows fires at the Tver oil terminal following the strike.



The larger shift for Washington came off the Ankara summit, which wrapped 8 July.

- President Trump told President Zelensky the US will license Ukraine to manufacture Patriot interceptors -- a long-standing Kyiv request -- and allies pledged roughly \$80 billion (about 70 billion euros) in 2026 assistance; Ukraine also concluded drone deals with Denmark, Estonia, and the Netherlands.
- We judge the Patriot license, if implemented, addresses Ukraine's single most acute shortfall -- interceptor supply against Russian missile and drone barrages -- though domestic production would take time to matter at scale. For Washington, the summit signaled continued allied burden-sharing even amid Trump's public friction with several allies, and Trump again suggested a negotiated end to the war may be within reach.

Prepared by ODNI with reporting from DIA, NGA, INR, and open sources.

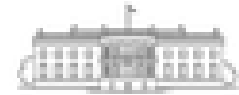
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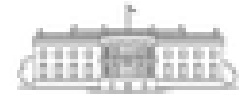
North Korea Formalizes Push To Expand Nuclear Forces

We assess Pyongyang has used a Central Military Commission session to lock in a decision to grow its nuclear forces "quantitatively and qualitatively," reaffirming that it will not bargain away its arsenal and is pairing warhead expansion with a naval-modernization drive.

- KCNA reported an enlarged Workers' Party Central Military Commission meeting on 9 July at which Kim Jong Un ordered measures to strengthen nuclear forces and modernize the military, framing a "powerful" force as the only guarantor of the country's security.
- The decision follows Kim's oversight of cruise-missile tests from a new 5,000-ton destroyer being readied for commissioning within two months -- continued investment in a sea-based strike capability.
- For Washington and Seoul the message is continuity and escalation: no path to denuclearization, a widening qualitative program, and a maturing naval leg. We expect further tests tied to the destroyer's induction and are watching for any new fissile-production or ICBM-related activity.

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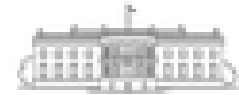
Taipei Warns Beijing's Gray-Zone Pressure Is Redrawing the Status Quo

We assess Beijing's incremental, below-threshold pressure on Taiwan is intended to normalize a new baseline of coercion, and that Taipei is now publicly framing it as a strategic rather than merely tactical challenge -- one it says Japan and the Philippines share.

- On 9 July a senior Taiwanese official warned that China's steadily escalating "gray-zone" activities risk changing the Taiwan Strait status quo "almost without notice," and that Taiwan, Japan, and the Philippines face the "same pattern" of deliberately sub-conventional pressure.
- The warning tracks with continued friction elsewhere: Beijing dismissed US and EU criticism of a new ethnic-unity law as interference, and a Chinese travel and business ban on the Philippine defense secretary is straining a fragile thaw with Manila.
- For Washington the difficulty is deterring a strategy engineered to avoid any single trigger for a response. We expect Taipei to press partners for a coordinated gray-zone playbook; the open question is whether the US and allies can raise the cost of coercion without handing Beijing a pretext to escalate.

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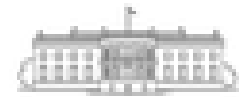
Gaza Ceasefire Holds Loosely as Talks Deadlock in Cairo

We assess the US-brokered Gaza ceasefire is intact in name but eroding at the edges, with continued Israeli strikes and a hard deadlock over the core issues that a new round of Cairo talks has yet to break.

- Gaza health and civil-defense officials reported at least six killed over the past 24 hours in Israeli strikes and gunfire despite the ceasefire; among recent casualties was a driver working for the US-based charity World Central Kitchen.
- Hamas chief negotiator Khalil al-Hayya arrived in Cairo for further talks that remain stuck on Hamas disarmament, Israeli troop withdrawal, and post-war governance.
- The US-led "Board of Peace" announced plans for a "pilot zone" near Rafah to move vetted civilians to the Israeli-controlled side of the Yellow Line -- an early test of the plan's next phase.
- For Washington the risk is that persistent strikes and a stalled track corrode a ceasefire it owns politically. We judge the near-term trajectory is continued low-level violence rather than outright collapse, absent a triggering mass-casualty event.

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Notes

- **Lebanon.** An Israeli drone strike on 9 July killed two people in the vicinity of Ghandour Hospital in Nabatieh al-Fawqa, the latest in a run of strikes testing the Israel-Lebanon ceasefire; Beirut calls them violations.
- **Sudan.** Humanitarian conditions worsened in Kordofan, with more than 800 cholera cases recorded in West Kordofan and continued clashes disrupting aid and driving displacement in Darfur; UN officials flagged child casualties in El Obeid.
- **China-Philippines.** Beijing's travel and business ban on the Philippine defense secretary, imposed over his criticism of negotiations with China, threatens a fragile easing in bilateral relations that Washington has an interest in preserving.

Prepared by ODNI with reporting from INR, CIA, DHS, and open sources.